

Delaware County Budget Hearings September 14th 2023 Segment #1

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qNO5x9eOVNc
Publication Date	2023-09-14T23:50:01Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Budget Work Session Meeting Summary

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript begins directly with the regular work session proceedings. No statutory public hearings or separate committee work sessions were held immediately prior to the call to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer [00:14:45](#) following a recess, noted to be shortly after 1:00 PM on a Thursday.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Not explicitly roll-called at opening, but active participants included Matt, Nancy, Fred, Bill, Ryan, Jean, and other council members alongside administrative staff.
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.

- **Presiding Officer:** The Council President / Lead Chair (unnamed explicitly in the opening transcript text, acting as presiding officer).
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not addressed during this session.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:14:45 Personnel Transfer Request (Fred):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred (Department Head)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Fred requested informal consensus/blessing to backfill/transfer an existing position starting the first week of October, prior to the official council vote scheduled for the end of the month. Members confirmed support.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informal consensus granted by voice (No formal vote taken as requested).
- **00:15:59 Auditor's Office & Treasurer's Office Budget & Revenue Review:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed (Auditor's Office), Tanya, Brad (Treasurer), Nancy, and Council Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive review and balancing of the 2024 County General and LIT (Local Income Tax) Public Safety budgets. Detailed reconciliation of fund give-backs, state-mandated costs (probation, sheriff, court administration, and public defender adjustments), property tax levies, miscellaneous revenues, and interest income projections. Brad (Treasurer) presented updated interest earnings estimates, projecting \$4.7 million in interest over the next 18 months, with potential to move funds into higher-yield accounts (up to 5.4%) requiring future council approval.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational and worksheet adjustments only; no formal roll-call or voice votes taken on individual budget cuts during this segment.
- **00:12:44 Health Insurance Program & Broker Report (Apex Benefits):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Pam (HR) and Bill Sylvester (Apex Benefits Advisor/Broker).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Detailed presentation regarding self-funded health insurance plans, the "Medicare plus 20%" pricing structure, pharmacy benefit management (PBM) carve-outs, reinsurance/stop-loss thresholds (\$200,000 deductible), and long-term financial trends. Discussion centered on the sustainability of employee contribution rates (unchanged since 2015 except once) and potential future long-term fund reserves.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.

- **02:25:13 LIT Public Safety & County General Budget Adjustments (Sheriff, Prosecutor, Jail, Commissioners):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tanya, Nancy, Ed, and Council Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Step-by-step line-item adjustments across LIT Public Safety budgets (Sheriff, Prosecutor, Jail) and County General (Commissioners, Council, and miscellaneous departments) modifying FICA, PERF, health insurance estimates, and contractual services (e.g., reducing Baker Tilly advisory services back to 2023 levels of \$150,000).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus adjustments made directly to working spreadsheets; no formal roll-call votes recorded.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public comment period or citizen forum was held during this internal budget work session.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The council scheduled a follow-up work session to review finalized insurance numbers and remaining budget gaps for **Wednesday, the 20th at 3:00 PM 02:21:50**.
 - Budget adoption is officially scheduled for **Friday, September 29th 01:31:55**.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Consensus to recess.
 - **Time:** Not explicitly stated in the transcript text, concluding immediately following the scheduling announcement.
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